

RAJESH DAMMALA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical Lead with 16+ years driving production deployment, operational readiness, and fleet reliability for large-scale infrastructure at Microsoft and IBM. Directly responsible for deployment operations across 20+ mission-critical production services — defining deployment processes, operational playbooks, escalation paths, and reliability practices in 24/7/365 environments. Proven track record building and leading globally distributed engineering teams (up to 32 engineers), staying hands-on through failure analysis, operational debugging, and system-level decision-making. Architected AI-driven automation platform achieving 30-35% automated resolution, built observability tooling increasing fleet monitoring coverage 3x, and drove operational efficiency from 85% to 98%. Deep experience with Azure infrastructure, data center operations, infrastructure automation, and cross-functional execution across systems, software, networking, and operations teams.

CORE COMPETENCIES

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Production Deployment & Fleet Operations• Deployment Playbooks & Escalation Frameworks• Observability & Fleet Monitoring• Incident Response & Root-Cause Analysis• Data Center Operations & Integration• High-Velocity Execution Under Ambiguity | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Operational Readiness & Reliability Engineering• Infrastructure Automation & Tooling• Cross-Functional Technical Execution• Failure Analysis & Operational Debugging• Engineering Team Leadership & Mentoring• AIOps & Automated Resolution Systems |
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SELECTED IMPACT

- Owned deployment operations and production readiness for 20+ mission-critical services in 24/7/365 data center environments — defined deployment processes, operational playbooks, readiness criteria, and escalation paths ensuring reliable, repeatable production deployment.
- Architected AI-driven operational automation platform (Azure SRE Agent) achieving 30–35% automated incident resolution, reducing fleet downtime and saving 150+ engineering hours/year through intelligent triage and auto-remediation.
- Built observability and monitoring infrastructure — designed KQL/Power BI dashboards tracking deployment readiness, fleet health, reliability metrics, and operational performance; increased monitoring coverage 3x.
- Led cross-functional execution across systems, software, infrastructure, networking, and operations teams — drove alignment through complex deployment and production issues with clear communication and strong technical judgment.
- Built and led globally distributed 32-person engineering team providing 24/7 coverage for production operations — established hiring practices, career development paths, and engineering culture grounded in ownership and technical rigor.
- Drove operational efficiency from 85% to 98% by identifying gaps in tooling, automation, and validation coverage, building plans to close them, and establishing clear metrics for operational health.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Lead — Deployment & Production Operations, Xbox CXT SRE

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra/Allyis) | Redmond, WA (Remote from Morrisville, NC) | May 2021 – Present

- Lead deployment operations and production readiness for 20+ mission-critical services in 24/7/365 data center environments — own the path from validation through production deployment, operational readiness, and sustained fleet support.
- Define deployment processes, operational playbooks, technical readiness criteria, escalation paths, and reliability practices for production platforms, ensuring reliable and repeatable deployment at scale.
- Drive cross-functional execution across systems, software, infrastructure, networking, and operations teams — coordinate lab validation, system integration, deployment, fleet monitoring, debugging, and issue resolution.
- Stay hands-on technically through architecture reviews, deployment planning, failure analysis, operational debugging, and critical system-level decision-making during high-severity production incidents.
- Identify gaps in tooling, observability, automation, and validation coverage — build plans to close them; increased fleet monitoring dashboard coverage 3x.
- Architected Azure SRE Agent platform for automated operational triage and resolution — 30-35% auto-resolution rate, significantly reducing production impact duration.
- Establish clear metrics for deployment readiness, reliability, performance, and operational health — built KQL/Power BI dashboards driving data-informed decisions.
- Authored 175+ operational playbooks in 5 months — standardized deployment procedures, debugging workflows, and escalation processes; reduced repeat issues by 40%.

- Drove operational efficiency from 85% to 98% through systematic process improvement, tooling investment, and metrics-driven goal setting.
- Mentor and develop engineers — established competency frameworks, career paths, and feedback mechanisms; built engineering culture of ownership and technical rigor.
- Manage CI/CD pipelines (ADO/Git) for production deployment of Xbox support services — ensuring deployment quality, safety, and velocity.
- Participate in 24/7 on-call rotation as directly responsible individual for production operations and incident response.

Infrastructure Operations Lead — Azure Enterprise Support

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 – May 2021

- Led team of 15 engineers driving infrastructure deployment, operational readiness, and production support for enterprise Azure cloud services.
- Managed deployment planning, operational readiness, incident response, debugging, and root-cause analysis for complex production systems across distributed infrastructure.
- Championed 200+ tooling improvements and feature enhancements — identified gaps in observability and automation, built plans to close them, improving deployment quality and fleet reliability.
- Coordinated cross-functional execution across systems, software, infrastructure, and networking teams to resolve complex production issues.

Operations Lead — Azure Data Center & LiveSite Operations

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India | Redmond, WA | May 2012 – Nov 2016

- Built and led globally distributed 32-person engineering team (Hyderabad + Redmond) providing 24/7 coverage for Azure data center and production operations.
- Led deep-dive technical investigations for complex production failures — hands-on debugging at cluster-to-blade level across very large distributed data center environments.
- Developed PowerShell automation frameworks for infrastructure deployment, system validation, and operational triage — saved thousands of manual hours annually.
- Managed production lifecycle: deployment readiness, system integration, fleet monitoring, change management, incident response, and post-incident reliability reviews.

Systems Engineer / Data Center Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 – Nov 2011

- Enterprise server builds, cluster configuration, rack integration, and large-scale data migrations in production data center environments.
- Hardware lifecycle management: system deployment, patching, service packs, validation, and decommissioning across enterprise infrastructure.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.E., Computer Science Engineering — JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

- AZ-900 Azure Fundamentals
- Microsoft 70-533/70-534: Implementing Azure Infrastructure Solutions
- TechMahindra AI White Belt | Google Generative AI | Google Cloud Computing Foundations

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & Deployment: Azure Data Center Operations, Production Deployment, Fleet Operations, Rack/System Integration, Hardware Lifecycle

Observability & Monitoring: Azure App Insights, Log Analytics, Kusto/KQL, Power BI, Geneva, Fleet Health Dashboards, Alerting Systems

Automation & Tooling: PowerShell, Infrastructure Automation, AIOps, AI Agents, Logic Apps, CI/CD Pipelines (ADO/Git), Bicep

Operations: Incident Response, Root-Cause Analysis, Failure Analysis, Operational Debugging, Change Management, Deployment Readiness

Leadership: Engineering Team Leadership (32 engineers), Cross-Functional Execution, Hiring & Talent Development, High-Velocity Execution